MediaTek Inc.

3Q26 revenue beats guidance on SoC pull-ins; TPUv8t ramping in 4Q, while v9 should tape out as scheduled

Overweight

2454.TW, 2454 TT
Price (08 Oct 26):NT$4,690.00
Price Target (Jun-27):NT$5,600.00

- **3Q26 revenue came in ahead of JPMe/consensus; TPU v8t revenues expected to kick in from 4Q26:** MediaTek Sep revenue came in at NT $55.4bn, up 2% YoY and down 14% MoM. 3Q26 sales came in at NT$168bn, up 10% QoQ and 18% YoY, ahead of JPMe/consensus estimates by ~8% and surpassing the high end of guidance by ~5% (3Q26 guidance NT$152.2bn-159.8bn). We believe the strong 3Q26 revenue was driven by smartphone pull-in ahead of MediaTek's planned SoC price increases and very small revenue contribution for TPUv8t, given the start of initial shipments. We expect GMs to be around the mid-point of guidance (JPMe 46%, company guided 44.5%-47.5%) as the benefit from price hikes is likely to be offset by rising cost pressures from Foundry, OSAT and substrates. For 4Q26, we expect revenue to be up 35%+ QoQ mainly due to TPU v8t revenues starting to flow through and expect GMs to decline by 1.5ppts QoQ to 44.5% with FY26 GMs at 45.6%.
- **TPUv8t Zebrafish ramp remains on track; TPUv9 Humufish progressing toward final tape-out by year-end:** Recent investor discussion has been focused on delays in TPUv8t ramp, v9 tapeout and uncertainty on v10 allocation. Based on our checks, MediaTek's TPUv8t Zebrafish continues to ramp on schedule at TSMC, and remains on track to generate $2bn+ in revenues in 2026. For 2027, we see potential unit upside, driving Datacenter ASIC revenues to ~$18bn, above the company's recent $12-16bn guidance range, especially as MediaTek appears to be able to bring on more substrate vendors. Our checks also indicate that TPUv9 Humufish is progressing well, with several chiplet-level tape-outs already completed on N3 and N2, and we continue to expect final tape-out in 4Q26. We would expect some noise around tapeout for TPUv9, similar to all other ASICs, given most new ASICs, GPUs are now going through at least two tapeouts before entering mass production. The next watch points for the stock are: (1) TPUv9 tapeout (likely in Nov-Dec, in our view); (2) award of TPU v10 CTO version, which we expect in the next few months after the recent delays; and (3) any new customer projects being confirmed, likely SPCX/TSLA ASIC. Looking ahead, we continue to see MediaTek's Datacenter ASIC revenues scaling toward $80-100bn annual revenue run-rate by 2030, as long as AI compute demand stays strong.

Technology and Telecoms

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Investment Thesis, Valuation and Risks

MediaTek Inc. *(Overweight; Price Target: NT$5,600.00)*

Investment Thesis

We are OW on MediaTek, given its TPU opportunity should continue to grow over the next 4-5 years and has the ability to reach $80-100bn annual run-rate by 2030E. We believe that Mediatek is likely to have majority unit share within TPUv8 (in 2027), be the primary ASIC vendor for TPUv9 with a sharp jump in ASPs, and is in pole position to emerge as the primary ASIC partner for TPUv10 with rising ASP per chip. For TPUv10, we expect Mediatek to provide I/O die, high-speed Serdes and other interconnect IP, overall packaging design and program management, with business model similar to v9. We also believe that the market is underestimating the OP leverage from the ASIC ramp, which should drive significant upside to EPS ests in the next 2 years, once ASIC revenues start flowing through.

Valuation

Our Jun-27 PT of NT$5600 is based on a 24x PE multiple (using straight PE from SoTP, given ASICs are now the dominant earnings driver), higher than past 10-year average, reflecting stronger growth for future TPU opportunity.

Risks to Rating and Price Target

Key downside risks include: (1) further pressure on Smartphone SoC GMs due to cost escalations and increased competition; and (2) slower progress on the NVDA partnership, given NVDA's expanded engagement with Intel and other chip makers.

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17-Oct-23	N	840.00	780
29-Oct-23	N	801.00	750
05-Jan-24	N	928.00	800
01-Feb-24	N	966.00	880
11-Apr-24	N	1195.00	1,050
28-Apr-24	N	1005.00	1,060
29-Jul-24	N	1245.00	1,050
01-Aug-24	N	1220.00	1,150
22-Oct-24	N	1330.00	1,175
31-Oct-24	N	1290.00	1,180
05-Feb-25	N	1490.00	1,275
27-Apr-25	N	1380.00	1,350
16-Jun-25	N	1250.00	1,300
25-Nov-25	N	1150.00	1,260
28-Jan-26	N	1775.00	1,525
05-Feb-26	N	1800.00	1,600
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31-May-26	OW	4310.00	5,300
31-Aug-26	OW	3985.00	5,600

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